NADIA BRENNAN-AZIZ

Senior Platform / Site Reliability Engineer

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior platform and site reliability engineer with 10 years of infrastructure experience, including six years operating Kubernetes platforms on AWS. Hands-on experience designing and operating cloud infrastructure, building Terraform-based platforms and self-service tools, and improving reliability and observability. Technical lead for a five-person platform team, with experience bringing product stakeholders into SLO and error-budget decisions.

CORE SKILLS

Cloud and infrastructure: AWS (EKS, EC2, VPC, IAM, RDS, S3, SQS, Route 53, CloudFront), Terraform, Atlantis, Crossplane, Karpenter
Platform and containers: Kubernetes, Helm, Kustomize, Argo CD, GitOps, GitHub Actions
Reliability and observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, Alertmanager, OpenTelemetry, SLOs and error budgets, incident management, k6
Programming and systems: Go, Python, Bash, Linux, Puppet

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Platform Engineer | Tallybrook Ltd (B2B accounting SaaS) *Apr 2022 – Present*
Manchester / remote

- Technical lead for a five-person platform team operating an AWS EKS platform spanning eight clusters, approximately 350 services and three regions.
- Designed and built an internal developer platform with Go and Python service templates, Argo CD GitOps, and Crossplane self-service provisioning for RDS, SQS and S3 through pull requests. Adopted by all 14 product teams; reduced time from new service to production from approximately two weeks to under one day.
- Introduced SLOs, burn-rate alerts and error budgets for the 20 most critical services, agreeing the error-budget policy with product leadership. Reduced on-call pages per week by approximately 60%.
- Replaced cluster-autoscaler managed node groups with Karpenter and spot instances for stateless workloads, including interruption handling. Reduced EC2 spend by 38% (approximately £410,000 per year).
- Participate in the incident commander rotation and established the incident and post-mortem process.

Site Reliability Engineer | Brightwater Games *Jan 2019 – Mar 2022*
Leeds

- Operated AWS game-backend infrastructure using EC2, ECS and later EKS for titles with up to 1.2 million daily active players.
- Managed AWS infrastructure with Terraform across approximately 40 modules, using Atlantis for plan and apply workflows on pull requests.
- Replaced a noisy Nagios setup with Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager and Loki observability.
- Ran k6 load tests and launch capacity planning; a test simulating 300,000 concurrent players identified a connection-pool limit that was fixed before launch.

Linux Systems Engineer | Pennine Hosting *Jul 2016 – Dec 2018*
Sheffield

- Managed approximately 600 Linux servers for hosting customers using Puppet configuration

management.
- Automated operational tasks with Bash and Python and provided on-call support for customer incidents.

SELECTED PROJECT

Kubernetes preview-namespace cleanup operator | Open source, 2024

- Built a small Kubernetes controller in Go using controller-runtime to delete expired preview namespaces; received approximately 120 GitHub stars.

LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY

- Mentored three engineers transitioning from backend development into SRE.
- Speaker at a UK DevOps meetup in 2024: “SLOs that product managers care about”.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science | University of the North Moors | 2016

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) | 2021, renewed 2024
AWS Certified Solutions Architect – Professional | 2023

LANGUAGES

English (native) | Urdu (conversational)